THE R.I.S.E.™ ROADMAP

PRACTICAL PLANNING TOOLKIT

S - SUSTAIN

Business Readiness Checklist

Check the numbers before you commit your money.

BUILD YOUR OWN PLAN • 30 MINUTES

What you will walk away with

Create a basic cost picture, work out break-even sales and list what needs checking before an investment.

BEFORE YOU START

A business idea, estimated monthly costs, a rough selling price, and any written documents from the seller or partner.

Your 5 steps

01 **See your situation**

02 Work out the numbers

03 Compare choices

04 Plan 30 days

05 Review your progress

See your situation

A business can look profitable on paper and still run out of cash. Include setup costs and slow months.

STEP 1 OF 5 UNDERSTAND

My business idea and customer

What will I sell and to whom?

Cash I could genuinely put at risk (RM)

Not emergency or household bill money

One-time setup costs (RM)

Renovation, equipment, deposits, setup

Cash kept for slow months (RM)

Separate from setup costs

Monthly business cost list

Business cost	RM / month	Fixed or per sale?

REMEMBER

A preschool, franchise or centre has its own permits, staffing, premises and operating checks. Do not assume approval or enrolment.

THREE QUESTIONS TO KEEP IN MIND

1. Who will pay for this product or service?
2. What will it cost before the first sale?
3. How much could you lose if sales are slow?

Work out the numbers

Break-even means income covers estimated operating costs, before financing, taxes and other items you may still need to include.

STEP 2 OF 5

DO THE MATHS

A SIMPLE EXAMPLE

EXAMPLE: Fee RM250; direct cost RM90/customer; RM160 left per customer. Fixed costs RM8,000/month: 8,000 / 160 = 50 paying customers just to break even.

Now use your own numbers

Selling price per customer (RM)

Direct cost per customer (RM)

Money left per customer (RM)

Price minus direct cost

Fixed costs per month (RM)

Customers needed to break even

Fixed costs divided by money left per customer

Customers expected in a slow month

WHAT YOUR NUMBER TELLS YOU

If expected slow-month sales are below break-even, work out how long your cash can cover the shortfall. If price does not exceed direct cost, the model needs rethinking.

A NOTE BEFORE YOU ACT

These are simple estimates, not a feasibility study. Check tax, wages, financing, licences, occupancy, repairs and working cash.

Compare your options

A good next step should fit your money, time and responsibilities - not only your hopes.

STEP 3 OF 5 EXPLORE

1 **Test a small version**

Speak to customers and test demand before paying for a full setup.

2 **Review written numbers**

Ask for actual cost details, occupancy and historical data, not only optimistic forecasts.

3 **Get independent checks**

Confirm licences, contracts and obligations with qualified specialists.

Compare your choices

What proof of demand?

Cash needed in slow months?

What rules or permits apply?

Before you decide, ask yourself

- [ ] Who owns the premises, brand and customer contracts?
- [ ] What do fixed costs look like with fewer customers?
- [ ] Are there any licences, fees, deposits or exit penalties?

Your 30-day action plan

Four small weekly steps are usually easier to keep than one big promise.

STEP 4 OF 5

TAKE ACTION

WEEK 1

Test the customer need

Speak to five potential customers without making promises.

My step:

WEEK 2

List every cost

Separate setup, fixed monthly and per-customer costs.

My step:

WEEK 3

Check the slow-month case

Model low sales, delays and extra operating expenses.

My step:

WEEK 4

Verify before paying

Review licences, contracts and numbers with independent professionals.

My step:

Make it real

My first action in the next 48 hours:

Date I will check my progress:

Review & take the next step

Come back after 30 days. A useful plan changes when life or the numbers change.

STEP 5 OF 5

KEEP IMPROVING

What I check	Initial estimate	After research
One-time setup cash (RM)		
Fixed monthly costs (RM)		
Break-even customers		
Slow-month cash shortfall (RM)		

Your reflections

Which assumption is most uncertain?

What would happen if sales took 6 months to grow?

What must be confirmed before I pay anything?

WHEN IT IS WORTH GETTING HELP

For a preschool or franchise, seek independent accounting, legal and regulatory checks before signing or investing.

Good questions to bring to a review

- Do these numbers make sense in a slow month?
- What is the total capital at risk, including hidden costs?

Want someone to help you see the bigger picture?

Chat with Balla DK on WhatsApp • No obligation

WHATSAPP →

RESEARCH & FURTHER READING

SSM - Starting a business

Business.gov.au - Financial terms

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